PANDA TOWERS 001 CMS | ADMINISTRATOR USER GUIDE

Blog & Articles Management Guide

Step-by-step instructions for creating, uploading, editing, publishing & deleting website articles

Purpose of This Guide

This manual provides step-by-step instructions for Panda Towers administrators and editors to independently create, format, upload images, publish, unpublish, and delete articles on https://pandatowers.africa without developer assistance.

1 Accessing the Blog & Articles Dashboard

1.1 Sign in to the CMS:
Open /login in your browser and sign in with your administrator email and password.

1.2 Open the Blog Module:
In the left sidebar under the "Content" section, click "Blog" (or navigate to /cms/blog).

1.3 Use Summary Filter Cards:
Click "Total Articles", "Published", "Drafts", or "Featured" at the top of the dashboard to filter articles by status.

1.4 Search, Filter & Switch Views:
Use the search bar to find articles by title, summary, slug, author, or category. Use the view toggle on the right to switch between Table View and Cards View.

2 Creating & Publishing a New Article

2.1 Click "New Article":
Click the green "New Article" button in the top-right corner of the Blog dashboard (/cms/blog/create).

2.2 Enter the Article Title:
Type your article headline in the "Article Title" field. The URL Slug and estimated Reading Time are generated automatically as you type.

2.3 Add an Excerpt / Summary:
Write a brief 1-2 sentence summary for blog cards, or click "Auto-fill from content" after writing your article body to generate one automatically.

2.4 Compose the Content Body:
Write and format your article in the Rich Content Editor using headings (H1, H2, H3), bold, italics, bulleted/numbered lists, blockquotes, and links.

2.5 Assign Author & Category:
In the right sidebar, select an Author Account or choose "Custom Author Name" to type any byline (e.g., "Panda Towers Research"). Choose a Category or click "+ New Category" to create one immediately.

2.6 Preview & Publish:
Click "Preview Article" in the top bar to see how your article looks on the Panda Towers website. Toggle "Publish on website" ON and click "Publish Now" (or click "Save as Draft" to save privately).

3 Uploading & Managing Article Images

3.1 Featured Cover Image:
In the right sidebar under "Featured Cover Image", drag and drop an image file (JPG, PNG, WebP, or GIF up to 10 MB) or click "Upload File". Once uploaded, a live preview is shown.

3.2 Reusing Media Library Images:
Click "Browse Library" to search previously uploaded images by filename and click "Use Selected Image".

3.3 Inserting Inline Content Images:
Place your cursor inside the Content Body editor where you want an image to appear, click the Image icon in the editor toolbar, and choose an image from your computer.

4 Editing, Publishing & Unpublishing Articles

4.1 Edit an Existing Article:
On /cms/blog, click the article title or the Pencil (Edit) icon in the Actions column. Update any field and click "Save & Update Article".

4.2 One-Click Publish / Unpublish:
On the /cms/blog table, click any article's green "Published" badge to unpublish it (move to Drafts), or click its amber "Draft" badge to publish it live to the website in one click.

4.3 One-Click Featured Spotlight:
Click the Star icon in the Actions column (or toggle "Featured article" in the editor) to pin the article as the featured spotlight story at the top of the website blog page.

4.4 Bulk Actions:
Tick the checkboxes next to multiple articles in the table to "Publish Selected", "Move to Drafts", or "Delete Selected" all at once.

5 Managing Categories & Deleting Articles Safely

5.1 Manage Blog Categories:
Click "Categories" in the top header of /cms/blog (or visit /cms/blog-categories) to add, rename, recolor, or delete categories. Deleting a category does not delete its articles.

5.2 Delete an Article:
Click the red Trash (Delete) icon next to an article and confirm the dialog prompt. If the article is currently live on the website, a warning message will alert you before deletion.

> **Important Safeguard: Unpublish vs. Delete**
> Deleting an article permanently removes it and its content from the database. If you only want to hide an article temporarily from the public website, click its status badge to Unpublish (Move to Draft) instead of deleting it.